

the Windows Phone user experience, these transitions play an important role, because they provide context for what you are doing, and where you are navigating within the UI..

You can see motion and animation in the live tiles on the Windows Phone Start screen as well. These tiles provide animations as a tease for what you'll see if you should tap them. The People tile animates with a moving kaleidoscope of your contacts' photos, for example. As Microsoft says, "live tiles use motion to engage the user, to pull them in." Motion and animation, of course, are hard to capture in the static screenshots found in this book. For this reason, we recommend getting your hands on a Windows Phone so you can see it in person. A Windows Phone feels alive and vibrant, ready for action, whereas your typical smart phone, iPhone and Android provide just a boring, static grid of icons; a UI that requires you to do all the work. With Windows Phone, you'll feel compelled to explore. It's an entirely different kind of experience.

Content and typography

In keeping with the use of white space noted previously, Windows Phone further differentiates itself from other smart phones by putting content front and center. Microsoft contends, correctly the phone will be a personal, intimate device; a life companion. So instead of designing the Metro UI with applications at the forefront, Windows Phone lets content be the interface. You no longer have to think about which application to launch when you want to access a favorite photo. Instead, you just access the Pictures experience, which combines photos and images from any number of applications and online services. That these locations contain not just your own photos, but photos from your friends and family too, is just the icing on the cake.



Clean UI